independence and authority.[24]

Some of the proposals of the former Secretary-General, which were accepted, were:

1. Creation of the position of a Deputy Secretary-General, and the setting up of a senior management group and a strategic planning unit.
2. Strengthening of the United Nations Office at Vienna while downgrading the authority of the Nairobi and Addis Ababa offices.
3. Replacement of the Committee on Administrative Coordination by the Chief Executive Board.
4. Merger of several departments into one, creation of new departments, and either integration of the United Nations information centres in the resident coordinator's office or their consolidation in regional information hubs.
5. Application of the zero-growth budget, suppression by attrition of personnel posts coupled with the creation of a staff college, reduction of administrative expenditure by 33 per cent, and transfer of such savings to a development account, and reduction of documentation by 30 per cent.
6. Adoption of reforms regarding the UN development activities in the field by establishing a UN House, creating the position of the UN system's resident coordinator, and by enhancing collaboration with civil society components in tackling the various challenges of the world.[25]

For the present Secretary-General, Ban Ki-moon, reform of the UN is a top priority, thereby enhancing its relevance and effectiveness for the world's people in the twenty-first century. With the Organization engaged in a range of pressing global issues in every part of the world, a renewed, revitalized and more responsive United Nations is needed more than ever before.

In January 2008, Secretary-General Ban Ki-moon outlined the broad fronts on which the United Nations needs to advance if it is to meet the challenges facing the member states and their peoples in the twenty-first century. In areas like the environment, public health and